

9.7 ActionScript 2.0

Introduction

The scripting language in Flash is known as ActionScript. Although there's no language that it follows, it's similar to Object Oriented Programming Structure.

ActionScripts can be attached to the frame of a timeline, to a button to make it interactive and to a movie clip. ActionScript finds its use in developing multimedia-based software, interactive CD ROM presentations, complex animations and many other purposes.

ActionScripts are available in many versions. ActionScript 1, 2 and the latest version, 3. ActionScript 3 is basically an advanced version, and mainly expert programmers work with it. On the other hand, ActionScript 2 is comparatively easy to understand, and is ideal for beginners. Before we start, let's understand the basic difference between ActionScript 2 and Action Script 3.

9.8 Differences Between ActionScript 2.0 And 3.0

The Compile-time type checking and the class-based syntax are the main features of ActionScript 2. The Class based syntaxes are nothing but the keywords class and extends. The class based inheritance syntaxes are also introduced in the ActionScript 2. This is extremely helpful for developers as they can easily create classes and interfaces in ActionScript 2. Previously, it was possible only in Java and C++.

ActionScript 3 is the updated version of ActionScript. It includes not only the features of ActionScript 2, but also includes some additional features. The ActionScript 3 is so different a scripting language that a completely different virtual machine i.e., Flash Player 9 is required to run the script. The Flash Player 9 includes two virtual machines. AVM2 is used to write the contents of the ActionScript 3.